

module-12-movement-of-sun - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - primary band

Module 12 — Movement of the Sun (Darśana)

Sanskrit: *Sūrya-gati* · **Band:** Primary (3-5) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

Solar year, solstices, equinoxes, and the 12 rāśis.

Darśana note. This workshop condenses Module 12's full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

Opening hook · 5 min

“Where did the sun rise today? Where will it set?” Point. “Did you know the sunrise direction CHANGES through the year? Today we learn why.”

Core idea · 15 min

The Sun moves on a big yearly path:

- **Uttarāyaṇa (उत्तरायण)** — northward course — Dec to June — days get longer
- **Dakṣiṇāyana (दक्षिणायन)** — southward course — June to Dec — days get shorter

Two special days: - **Solstice** — sun is at its farthest north (June) or south (Dec) - **Equinox** — day = night (March 21, Sept 22)

12 zodiac signs (rāśis) for 12 months: chant them — Meṣa, Vṛṣabha, Mithuna, Karkāṭa, Siṁha, Kanyā, Tulā, Vṛścika, Dhanus, Makara, Kumbha, Mīna.

Demonstration · 10 min

In a sunny window: mark today's sunrise direction. Compare with a marked sunrise direction from 3 months ago (or imagine). Show the chant: *“Uttarāyaṇa! Dakṣiṇāyana!”*

Source moment · 5 min

Tell the story of how the Sun visits 12 houses (rāśis) each year, taking one month at each — like a friend visiting 12 cousins.

Hands-on activity · 15 min

Each child marks 4 special days on a year-circle (Mar 21, Jun 21, Sep 22, Dec 21) and labels them. Decorate.

Reflection + take-home · 10 min

Each child says one thing they learned about the Sun. Cheer.

Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you're skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — Sun's yearly path
- **Day 02** — Axial tilt and seasons
- **Day 03** — Uttarāyaṇa and Dakṣiṇāyana
- **Day 04** — Equinoxes — viṣuva
- **Day 05** — 12 rāśis
- **Day 06** — Saṅkrānti moments
- **Day 07** — Sāyana vs nirayana — the ayanāṁśa
- **Day 08** — Precession of equinoxes
- **Day 09** — Cross-cultural calendars — solar systems
- **Day 10** — Final share + personal calendar

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.